Confirm your alectinib treatment setting This guide covers alectinib alone for ALK-positive lung cancer. Confirm whether it is adjuvant treatment after complete surgery, first treatment for advanced cancer, or treatment after crizotinib. These settings have different evidence and treatment lengths.

NATIONAL CANCER CONTROL PROGRAMME (NCCP) 00401 · VERSION 6

Alectinib monotherapy

Take alectinib twice daily with food, every day, with no planned rest week. After surgery, treatment lasts up to 24 months, stopping sooner for recurrence or unacceptable side effects. For advanced cancer, treatment continues until progression or unacceptable side effects under the oncology plan.

Make treatment fit into daily life

The usual starting dose is 600 mg twice daily: four 150 mg capsules each time, taken with food. Use your own prescription, which may specify a lower dose. Swallow capsules whole; do not open or dissolve them. If a dose is missed, take it only if the next dose is more than 6 hours away. If the next dose is due within 6 hours, skip the missed dose. Do not take two doses together. If you vomit after a dose, take the next dose at its usual time; do not take an extra dose.

Before starting

Confirm ALK result, treatment setting, dose, baseline tests and access. After crizotinib the team allows at least 7 days before alectinib.

Taking capsules

The usual starting dose is 600 mg twice daily: four 150 mg capsules each time, taken with food. Use your own prescription, which may specify a lower dose. Swallow capsules whole; do not open or dissolve them.

Missed or vomited dose

If a dose is missed, take it only if the next dose is more than 6 hours away. If the next dose is due within 6 hours, skip the missed dose. Do not take two doses together. If you vomit after a dose, take the next dose at its usual time; do not take an extra dose.

Supply and visits

Request the next supply before capsules run out. Blood tests and ECGs need their own appointments. Alectinib itself does not require a line or infusion pump.

A hold or dose change

Ask what is held, what needs to recover and who will authorise restarting. Do not restart or change the dose yourself.

Completion or change

Take alectinib twice daily with food, every day, with no planned rest week. After surgery, treatment lasts up to 24 months, stopping sooner for recurrence or unacceptable side effects. For advanced cancer, treatment continues until progression or unacceptable side effects under the oncology plan.

Who arranges each check?

Agree the due window, booking team, result reviewer and whom to contact if an appointment or result is missing. This reference page does not book or record a test.

Sources and review

The NCCP regimen supplies the treatment rules. Separate guidelines supply the longer-term monitoring recommendations, with their qualifications retained.

- NCCP 00401 v6 · official regimen
- EMA Alecensa product information, updated 31 March 2026
- NCCP NCIS Medical Oncology antiemetics V8, February 2025
- NCCP systemic anticancer therapy (SACT) nausea/vomiting classification V6, oral Tables 5 and 8
- ALINA primary analysis: resected ALK-positive non-small-cell lung cancer (NSCLC), 2024
- ALINA updated DFS, ESMO 2025 abstract 1787MO; cutoff 8 December 2024
- ALEX final OS analysis, 2025; cutoff 28 April 2025
- Ou et al: post-crizotinib single-arm phase II global study

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending